

MA. LOURDES L. SARMIENTO - ADATO, CPA

Villa Caceres Estates, City of Sta.Rosa, Laguna, Philippines

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PROFESSIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

- Finance operations leader with nearly two years of experience managing end-to-end accounting, treasury, and tax functions for a global beauty retail enterprise.
- Over nine years of progressive accounting and management experience within one of the country's largest retail companies, overseeing close processes and multi-entity operations.
- Former audit professional with almost four years of experience leading and executing statutory audits and agreed-upon procedures across holding companies, real estate, telecommunications, and professional services.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Finance Manager, July 2024 to present

Shiseido Philippines Corp. Taguig City, Philippines

- Ensured compliance with monthly close standards and timelines, maintaining accuracy and consistency across financial reporting.
- Prepared and reviewed Balance Sheets, Cash Flow Statements, and comprehensive reporting packages for HQ, RHQ, and JV partners, meeting both statutory and management reporting requirements.
- Managed cash flow and liquidity planning to support operational needs and optimize working capital.
- Oversaw tax and licensing compliance, coordinating with external tax consultants to ensure timely, accurate, and compliant filings.

Senior Accounting Manager – General Ledger Shared Services, August 2020 to November 2023

SM Retail, Inc. Pasay City, Philippines

- Served as Assistant Lead for the SM Retail General Ledger Shared Services
- Ensured timely and accurate compliance with the shared services closing calendar, meeting internal and external reporting deadlines.
- Accountable for the completeness and accuracy of fixed assets, bank reconciliations, and record-to-report activities.
- Reviewed and monitored GL-owned account reconciliations and performance dashboards.
- Managed team capacity and priorities, allocating workload to meet service-level expectations.
- Resolved escalated accounting issues, partnering with other shared services functions to ensure timely closure.
- Drove continuous process improvement initiatives to enhance efficiency, standardization, and control.
- Coordinated with external auditors, supporting audit requirements and ensuring compliance with statutory and regulatory standards.

Senior Accounting Manager, June 2016 to August 2020

Junior Accounting Manager, May 2014 to June 2016

ACE Hardware Phils., Inc.- subsidiary of SM Retail, Inc. Pasay City, Philippines

- Managed the monthly financial close process, ensuring all costs incurred are properly recorded, reviewing journal entries, account balance reconciliations and report preparation;
- Ensured the timely reporting of all monthly financial information and analysis;
- Performed review of company cash position;
- Prepared consolidation packages and other reports in compliance with group reporting standards;
- Collaborated with external auditors to ensure successful audit results and compliance; and
- Reported directly to Controller.

Senior Assurance Associate, August 2012 to May 2014

SyCip Gorres Velayo & Co. (SGV&Co.)- member practice of Ernst & Young Global, Makati City, Philippines

- Conducted overall financial statement analysis and investigate significant fluctuations noted;
- Prepared auditor's report and assisted clients' preparation of audited financial statements, income tax returns and analyses required by the Securities and Exchange Commission;
- Identified and communicated significant accounting and reporting issues to clients,

- Drafted management letters and recommendations to enhance clients' internal controls, business processes, and financial reporting systems.
- Supervised and mentored junior engagement team members.

Assurance Associate, December 2010 to August 2012

SyCip Gorres Velayo & Co. (SGV&Co.)- member practice of Ernst & Young Global, Makati City, Philippines

- Understood flows of transactions and relevant controls, performs walkthroughs and substantive audit procedures in accordance with the methodology required for the practice of the firm;
- Determined combined risk assessments and prepares audit strategies memorandum including summary review memorandum;
- Communicated with superiors significant issues identified during the course of the audit and propose resolutions to address such issues.

LICENSURE EXAMINATION PASSED and EXTRA CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- **CPA Licensure Examinations**, October 2010- General Weighted Average 90.24%;
- **Member, Philippine Institute of Certified Public Accountants**

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

College:	UNIVERSITY OF SANTO TOMAS España, Manila Degree: <i>Bachelor of Science in Accountancy</i> <i>Dean's Lister</i>	2006- 2010
High School:	HOLY ROSARY COLLEGE City of Sta. Rosa Laguna <i>4th Honorable Mention</i>	2002- 2006

SEMINARS/TRAININGS ATTENDED

ASSURANCE CORE SKILLS (I, II, III, IV)

A comprehensive course conducted annually covering topics about evaluating internal control, performing walkthrough, test of controls and substantive procedures and concluding the audit.

IFRS TRAININGS

IFRS Executive Annual Update
IFRS Workshop Part 1
Supplemental PFRS Update

SKILLS AND QUALITIES

- Accounting & Auditing Expertise
- ERP Systems: SAP & Oracle
- Advanced Microsoft Office Applications (Excel, Word, PowerPoint)
- Strong Analytical & Problem-Solving Abilities
- Ability to Manage Multiple Tasks & Work Under Pressure
- Effective Written and Verbal Communication
- Dependable, Goal-Oriented, and Self-Motivated

CHARACTER REFERENCES

Available upon request